dramas flourished in its large open spaces. F.E. Chaudhary, Lahore's first and all-time great news photographer, who died just before his 105th birthday in 2013, lamented the passing of its days of glory in his *Abb Woh Lahore Kahan*. Affectionately known as 'Chacha', he had much to lament about. He had seen the city's spiralling descent into decline and decay during his own lifetime.

The year 1921, when Bhagat Singh entered the National College, Lahore, was also the year when the Tilak School of Politics was founded on the same site. It was to be the turning point in Bhagat Singh's life. It was there that his intellectual transformation took place at the hands of such revolutionary teachers as Bhai Parmanand, Principal Chhabil Das and Professor Jaichandra Vidyalankar, who taught in the English medium. Vidyalankar at his home introduced Bhagat Singh to Sachindra Nath Sanyal, who went on to become the political guru of Bhagat Singh. These stalwarts rejected Gandhian non-violence in favour of a revolutionary overthrow of imperialism at a time of escalating anti-government feelings in Punjab. Bhagat Singh left National College, Lahore, in 1923 and fled for Kanpur without completing his degree when he came under family pressure to get married. In the process, he became the most famous icon of revolutionary pre-Independence India.

But then there was a reason why Bhagat Singh returned to Lahore to found the Naujawan Bharat Sabha at Bradlaugh Hall in 1926. A year earlier, the revolutionary movement had been all but vanquished when in 1925 ten men had ransacked the official treasury on a train in Lucknow which had been collecting monies from railway stations *en route*. Their purpose was to use the money thus looted from the train to fund the purchase of weaponry that they desperately needed to take on the British Raj. They were in a struggle for national freedom. However, those who had masterminded the robbery, namely Ram Prasad Bismil and Ashfaqullah Bismil, were tracked down, tried and sentenced to be hanged for their troubles. This was what became known as the Kakori Conspiracy Case of 1925. With this the leadership of the revolutionary movement had been destroyed in one stroke.